

RAJESH DAMMALA

Staff Escalation Manager - Full Portfolio Profile

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[Rajesh Dammala - Staff Escalation Manager](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Escalation management profile centered on customer-critical incidents, major response leadership, playbook-driven execution, and service improvement through operational data and structured feedback loops.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| • Escalation Management | • Customer Communication |
| • Service Recovery | • Major Incident Handling |
| • Operational Excellence | • Executive Reporting |
| • RCA | • Global Support Leadership |

SELECTED IMPACT

- Reduced issue resolution time by 32%.
- Central authority for high-severity incidents.
- Authored 175+ playbooks in 5 months.
- Managed high-volume, 24x7 mission-critical support operations.
- 16+ years across cloud operations, production engineering, escalation leadership, and data center environments
- 20+ mission-critical production services supported in 24x7x365 environments
- 30-35% incident automation potential delivered through AI-driven workflows
- 25,000+ stale or false incidents remediated
- 500+ noisy or redundant alerts streamlined
- 175+ troubleshooting guides and operational playbooks authored in 5 months
- 32% faster issue resolution through escalation framework redesign
- 85% to 98% operational efficiency improvement
- Teams led across global geographies: up to 32 engineers
- 200+ bugs and feature enhancements raised across Azure operations, ICM, JIT, and Key Vault onboarding
- ~122K USD estimated annual savings through AI copilots and automation initiatives
- 150+ engineering hours per year saved through automation and onboarding tooling

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Escalations Manager / SRE Program Lead

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra / Allyis) | May 2021 - Present

- Serve as central escalation authority for high-severity incidents across Xbox support services and adjacent production platforms.
- Architected Azure SRE Agent platform for AI-driven incident diagnostics, triage, and remediation workflows across non-production and production environments.
- Designed automation integrating ICM, Application Insights, Log Analytics, Azure DevOps, Kusto, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, and Microsoft Teams notifications.
- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through alert rationalization, stale incident cleanup, playbook standardization, and automation-driven triage.
- Remediated 25,000+ stale or false incidents and streamlined 500+ alerts to improve signal quality for engineering and operations teams.
- Authored 175+ troubleshooting guides and operational playbooks in 5 months, accelerating onboarding and reducing repeat investigation effort.
- Built Power BI and KQL dashboards for telemetry, service health, and LiveSite trends used in executive reviews and operational decision-making.
- Led AI enablement initiatives including ADO Bug Intelligence, RF Insights Copilot, CAD Support Copilot, and prompt library efforts.

- Managed production Azure DevOps build and release pipelines for Xbox support services, with emphasis on release quality, reliability, and controlled change.
- Supported 24x7x365 mission-critical systems and participated directly in on-call and incident command workflows.

Azure Support Technical Lead

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Nov 2016 - May 2021

- Led a team of 15 engineers supporting Azure customer workloads, enterprise subscriptions, capacity questions, data migrations, and cross-team technical issues.
- Spearheaded Azure chat support initiatives and improved service responsiveness through process and tooling improvements.
- Managed Azure subscription and enterprise agreement scenarios, region capacity questions, identity concerns, and migration issues for customers and internal teams.
- Partnered with Microsoft product and engineering groups to escalate customer-impacting issues and advocate for product enhancements.
- Drove support quality and operational maturity in high-volume cloud environments requiring technical depth and stakeholder clarity.

Operations Lead - Azure LiveSite Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | May 2012 - Nov 2016

- Led an operations organization spanning 12 senior engineers and 20 service engineers across Hyderabad and Redmond.
- Performed deep technical investigations into complex Azure production issues from cluster to blade level.
- Created PowerShell automation that saved thousands of manual hours annually across investigations, onboarding, and operational workflows.
- Drove Azure network monitoring, change management, incident handling, and large-scale service health investigations.
- Raised 200+ bugs and feature requests tied to ICM, JIT, Azure Key Vault onboarding, and operational platform improvements.

Systems Analyst / Support Engineer / Data Center Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

- Built and decommissioned enterprise servers, configured clusters, patched systems, and supported production data center operations.
- Migrated large data volumes and installed packaged tools and applications across server environments.
- Supported foundational infrastructure engineering practices including hardware lifecycle, environment readiness, and deployment execution.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering - JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional: Implementing Microsoft Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals
- TechMahindra AI White Belt
- Google Introduction to Generative AI
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- TechM Curated AI for Beginners

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Microsoft Azure, Azure App Service, Application Insights, Log Analytics, Azure Data Factory, Azure DevOps, Azure Key Vault, Azure Active Directory, Managed Identity, Azure Resource Groups, Cosmos DB, Front Door, Synapse

Observability and Operations: Kusto Query Language, Power BI, LiveSite Operations, Incident Command, Root Cause Analysis, MTTR Reduction, Alert Rationalization, SLA/SLO/SLI, Problem Management, Change Management

Automation and Engineering: PowerShell, Bicep, Infrastructure as Code, Logic Apps, CI/CD Pipelines, Git, REST APIs, SQL Server, Playwright, Python, ASP.NET Core

AI and Agentic Systems: Generative AI, AI copilots, Agentic workflows, Multi-agent orchestration, Azure SRE Agent, LLM-assisted diagnostics, Prompt libraries, AI-driven ticket triage

Leadership: Executive communication, Customer and stakeholder management, Cross-functional program delivery, Escalation leadership, Technical mentoring, Global team leadership, Operational excellence, Service delivery management